

VERBAL AND NON-VERBAL DELIVERY

Beyond just the words; your voice and your body

Moderating your voice for maximum impact

One word, when spoken in different ways, can have different meanings, implications and impact. Now imagine the different ways your speech can be changed when the same content is spoken in different ways and mannerisms.

Here are some of the ways your voice can be used as a tool in managing your audience and your speech:

- Volume: Volume refers to the relative softness or loudness of your voice. If you speak too softly ("too little" volume), your audience will struggle to hear and understand you and may give up trying to listen. If you speak with "too much" volume, your audience may feel that you are shouting at them, or at least feel uncomfortable with you shouting. The volume you use should fit the size of the audience and the room.
- Pitch: Pitch is the relative highness or lowness of your voice. You can vary the pitch of your voice at different points in the speech to boost the points being made. You do not want to vary your pitch too much (usually as a result of nerves), or too little which leads to a boring monotone.

Moderating your voice for maximum impact

(contd.)

- Rate: This refers to how quickly or slowly you say the words of your speech. If you speak too slowly, you sound like you are not confident and your audience will get bored. If you speak too quickly, your audience will not be able to keep up with you or digest what you are saying.
- Pauses: Some people assume that taking a pause in your speech is bad, but this is not true; afterall, you take pauses in your everyday conversations. Someone who pauses too often (after each sentence) may come off seeming like they don't know their speech very well. Someone who pauses too long (more than a few seconds), runs the risk of the audience feeling uncomfortable or, even worse becoming distracted or letting their attention wander.
- Other vocal aspects of delivery: speak clearly, learn the correct pronunciation of words, take speech therapy classes if you need to.

Non-verbal delivery

When not speaking is part of your speech

When speaking, your job is to create a captivating experience for your audience. Nonverbals provide an important part of that experience by amplifying your content and contributing to the experience.

In this chapter, we explore various nonverbal components that influence your message. This is not a checklist, rather a series of inter-related behaviours and practices.

- Eye contact: Next to clearly speaking an organized text, eye contact is another very important element of speaking. Eye contact creates an intimate and interpersonal experience for individual audience members and it assists in maintaining rapport. he general rule of thumb is that 80% of your total speech time should be spent making eye contact. Try to avoid the following methods of creating fake eye contact – (a) picking a few random points at the back and only looking only at those points, (b) where you are reading their speech and only looking up quickly and briefly, (c) only looking in one single direction.

Non-verbal delivery (contd.)

When not speaking is part of your speech

- Moving: Movement depends on two main considerations: 1) What's the space? And, 2) What's the message? If you have a fixed microphone, or a lectern, or seat, you may not be able to move as much. In addition to the space, your message and content assist in deciding how or why you might move around the space. It's necessary to ask, "how does movement support, enhance or detract from the message. Scenarios you should avoid in moving - (a) walking back and forth without any clear reason for the movement, (b) obstructing the view of the presentation or other visual aids.
- Facial expressions: Facial expressions are generally categorized as one of the following: happy, sad, angry, fearful, surprised and disgusted. Your facial expressions matter; your audience will be looking at your face to guide them through the speech, so they're an vital part of communicating meaning and demonstrating to your audience what they should feel.

Tips for non-verbal delivery

- Pay attention to your audience's nonverbal communication
- Your words should match your nonverbal communication
- Pay attention to the tone of your voice
- Use good eye contact
- Develop your emotional awareness
- Practice and ask for feedback on your nonverbal cues

CLASS EXERCISE 1:
HTTPS://WWW.TED.COM/TALKS/MATT_CUTTS_TRY_SOMETHING_NEW_FOR_30_DAYS?UTM_CAMPAIGN=TEDSPREAD&UTM_MEDIUM=REFERRAL&UTM_SOURCE=TEDCOMSHARE

WATCH AND DISCUSS.

CLASS EXERCISE 2:
HTTPS://WWW.TED.COM/TALKS/NILOFER_MERCHANT_GOT_A_MEETING_TAKE_A_WALK?UTM_CAMPAIGN=TEDSPREAD&UTM_MEDIUM=REFERRAL&UTM_SOURCE=TEDCOMSHARE

WATCH AND DISCUSS.